Shweta K. Sisodiya

Expected Graduation Date: Dec 2026

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Professional Summary

- **4+** years of experience in **mixed-methods UX research and Human-Centered artificial intelligence for social good**.
- **4** years of experience of contributing to **9** (5 product-based and 4 user-focused) research projects with **75+ Qualitative Interviews**, **25+ Usability Studies**, **10+ Co-Design**, **5 Machine Learning pipelines**, **6 Taxonomies**, leading to publication at **CHI'26(in review), TOCHI'26, CSCW'25, CHIPLAY'24, FDG'23, HCII'22**.

Education

Ph.D. University of California, Santa Cruz, USA, *Human-Computer Interaction* — Sep 2021 – Dec 2026

B.S. & M.S., Indian Institute of Technology Roorkee, INDIA, *Applied Mathematics* — Jul 2013 – May 2018

Work Experience

PhD Researcher, Interaction Dynamics Lab at UCSC, USA — Sep 2021 – Dec 2026

- **Proposed qualitative research method**, "PDCS", a 90-minute study, delivered insights comparable to year-long ethnographic studies, combined theories of participatory storytelling, qualitative interviews, and survey development.**(In review at CHI'26)**.
- **Executed and validated the method ("PDCS")** across two studies with **75 international students**, with 85% reporting higher enjoyment and satisfaction, and yielding **500+ user narratives**.
- Curated a dataset of 500+ user narratives using PDCS for **benchmarking and fine-tuning LLM**, and continuing research on the design of a **human-in-the-loop framework for Agentic AI**.
- Designed and implemented robust data pipelines for qualitative analysis, handling $10M+$ Reddit comments, leveraging LLM-based clustering, sentiment analysis, and PRAW for web scraping.
- **Proposed distinct taxonomies** and **15+ design recommendations** for reimagining LLM tools for international students, by leading thematic analysis. **(Accepted at ToCHI '26)**.

User Experience (UX) Research Internship, Honda Research Institute, USA — Jun 2023 – Aug 2023

- Identified **15 critical design and functionality misalignments** across the Unity-based VR Simulator built for the Honda Research team by leading **13 usability studies**.
- Developed **knowledge management system**, boosting the UX research team's **productivity by 25%**, by consolidating insights from hundreds of hours of **usability studies and interviews** conducted by 5 UX researchers.
- Designed a **Plotly-based Interactive Dashboard**, enabling data-driven design decisions for the Honda team, by collecting **human subject requirements via usability studies to monitor eye-tracking** and VR simulator usage metrics.

User Experience (UX) Research Internship, Honda Research Institute, USA — Jun 2022 – Aug 2022

- Defined **8 user needs** for Unity-based VR Social Simulator, conducted and synthesized results from **12 qualitative interviews**.
- Delivered **21 prototype sketches** addressing $\sim 80\%$ of user needs, by leading co-design workshops with 12 human subjects.
- Proposed **5 design recommendations** inceasing the user **efficacy by** $\sim 25\%$, by leading **5 usability studies**.

Data Scientist, Accenture, India — Aug 2018 – Aug 2021

- Deployed production-grade ML pipelines, generating synthetic forecasts using time-series models (Baesyian Forecasting, ARIMA), by implementing statistical reconciliation and standard NLP models (TF-IDF) for data consistency.
- Produced impactful findings for global stakeholders, applying predictive modeling using classification (Random Forests) and statistical methods, to directly influence business strategy and decision-making.
- Engineered a fully automated **ETL pipeline**, reducing an analyst's weekly **workload by** 25%, by streamlining data availability for client reporting using **Python, scheduling tools, and version control**.

Latest Publications

- "No One Talks About How Long It Takes Just to Be a Person Here." Reimagining Technical Support for International Students. *ACM TOCHI'26*. **(Accepted)**
- Background Media: Colloquial Assistive Technology for Neurodivergent People. *ACM CSCW'25*. **(Accepted)**
- Persona-Driven Collaborative Storytelling: Participatory Information Gathering for International Student Communities. *ACM CHI'26*. **(Under Review)**

Skills

- **Research Methods:** Storytelling and Ethnographic Methods, Interviews, Focus Groups, Surveys, Contextual Inquiry, Co-design Workshops, Diary Studies, Persona, Journey Mapping, Participatory Design, Qualitative research, Usability Studies, A/B testing.
- **Tools:** Figma, Notion, Obsidian, Miro, Tableau, Jupyter Notebook, Visual Studio Code.
- **Programming Languages:** Python (Pytroch), HTML, CSS, JavaScript, R, SQL.